BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Required safety checks and your individual cancer-assessment plan

These stages are not equal time intervals. Your team provides dates and reviews results. There is no universal blood tumour-marker panel or scan interval in this guide.

Check	Before starting	During treatment	Between visits	Response review	After treatment
Bloods and organ safety	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review kidney-function measurement, earlier platinum reactions, nerve and hearing symptoms and all medicines.	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests before every cycle. The team verifies the current kidney result and dose calculation, and reviews infection, bleeding, hearing and nerve symptoms.	New symptoms may require extra tests before the next planned review.	Safety bloods do not by themselves show whether treatment controls the cancer.	Continue mouth, swallowing, dental, skin and nutrition care after radiation. Blood tests and hearing or nerve review follow any persisting problem; scans and examinations follow your individual oncology and radiation plan.
Concurrent radiotherapy	Dental, nutrition and swallowing preparation; obtain a separate radiation calendar.	Attend radiation on the prescribed calendar; it is not given only on carboplatin days.	Tell the team about missed sessions, skin reactions and worsening mouth or swallowing symptoms.	The radiation and oncology teams coordinate changes.	Recovery and dental or swallowing effects may continue after the final radiation session.
Head and neck function	Record weight, intake, swallowing, speech and existing mouth or dental problems.	Review pain, intake, weight and support needs.	Report choking, inability to drink, worsening swallowing or new neck symptoms.	Agree examinations and scans with the oncology team.	Continue rehabilitation and symptom support as needed.
Medicines and practical plan	Confirm the exact prescription, treatment aim and actual urgent contacts.	Bring your medicine list, current support plan and treatment record.	Record symptoms and medicines taken; ask before adding a new product.	Confirm any pause, dose change or stop in writing.	Record the final dose and the teams responsible for follow-up.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00261 v7: official regimen

Tests in your plan

Full blood count

WHEN

Before starting and before each treatment cycle

Checks blood cells and helps assess infection, anaemia and bleeding risk.

Kidney and liver tests

WHEN

Before starting and before each cycle

Checks organ function; kidney function is also used to calculate carboplatin dose.

Kidney-function measurement

WHEN

Baseline and repeat or reassess when clinically required; estimated dosing needs a current creatinine result.

Provides the renal value needed for the carboplatin dose calculation; measured function is preferred when feasible.

Scans and head and neck examination

If part of your plan

WHEN

As prescribed in the individual disease-assessment plan

Assesses the cancer and the response to treatment separately from safety bloods.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Carboplatin every 3 weeks with head and neck radiotherapy: treatment and checks

Locally advanced stage III–intravenous (IV) head and neck squamous cell carcinoma when cisplatin is not appropriate.

Carboplatin is given through a vein over about 30 minutes on Day 1 every 21 days. The head and neck prescription uses AUC 5, a target used with your checked kidney function to calculate the dose. The whole visit includes safety checks, anti-sickness medicines, preparation and observation. Three carboplatin cycles are planned with concurrent radiotherapy. Radiation has a separate appointment calendar; the team coordinates any interruptions or changes.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	During treatment	Between visits	Response review	After treatment
Bloods and organ safety NCCP	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review kidney-function measurement, earlier platinum reactions, nerve and hearing symptoms and all medicines.	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests before every cycle. The team verifies the current kidney result and dose calculation, and reviews infection, bleeding, hearing and nerve symptoms.	New symptoms may require extra tests before the next planned review.	Safety bloods do not by themselves show whether treatment controls the cancer.	Continue mouth, swallowing, dental, skin and nutrition care after radiation. Blood tests and hearing or nerve review follow any persisting problem; scans and examinations follow your individual oncology and radiation plan.
Concurrent radiotherapy NCCP	Dental, nutrition and swallowing preparation; obtain a separate radiation calendar.	Attend radiation on the prescribed calendar; it is not given only on carboplatin days.	Tell the team about missed sessions, skin reactions and worsening mouth or swallowing symptoms.	The radiation and oncology teams coordinate changes.	Recovery and dental or swallowing effects may continue after the final radiation session.
Head and neck function NCCP	Record weight, intake, swallowing, speech and existing mouth or dental problems.	Review pain, intake, weight and support needs.	Report choking, inability to drink, worsening swallowing or new neck symptoms.	Agree examinations and scans with the oncology team.	Continue rehabilitation and symptom support as needed.
Medicines and practical plan NCCP	Confirm the exact prescription, treatment aim and actual urgent contacts.	Bring your medicine list, current support plan and treatment record.	Record symptoms and medicines taken; ask before adding a new product.	Confirm any pause, dose change or stop in writing.	Record the final dose and the teams responsible for follow-up.

What each check is for

1

Carboplatin with radiotherapy

3 cycles every 3 weeks

Carboplatin is given with radiotherapy to treat locally advanced head and neck cancer when cisplatin is unsuitable. Your team explains the intended chance of cure or long-term control for your diagnosis.

Ask / act: Confirm the current phase, prescription, tests and support plan.

Sources: NCCP

2

Recovery and follow-up

After concurrent treatment

Carboplatin is given with radiotherapy to treat locally advanced head and neck cancer when cisplatin is unsuitable. Your team explains the intended chance of cure or long-term control for your diagnosis.

Ask / act: Confirm the current phase, prescription, tests and support plan.

Sources: NCCP

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-09 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.46